Andragogy

principles according to Knowles

Need to know

Self-concept

Experience

Disposition

Orientation

Motivation

Principles of Andragogy

- **Need to Know**: Adults need to know the reason why they should learn something. Before committing to learning, they typically want to understand why it is important and how it will benefit them.

- **Foundation**: Adults come with a reservoir of life experiences and knowledge. This can serve as a rich resource for learning, but it can also be a source of prejudices and biases. Effective adult education takes these experiences into account, building upon them and integrating new learning.

- **Self-concept**: As people mature, they move from being dependent learners (as children) to being self-directed learners. Adults prefer to take responsibility for their own decisions and their own learning. Thus, they prefer learning experiences that allow autonomy and self-direction.

- **Readiness to Learn**: Adults are ready to learn those things they need to know to deal with real-life situations. Often, this is in response to some real-world event such as facing a new role (e.g., becoming a parent) or a new job responsibility.

- **Orientation to Learning**: While children's learning is subject-oriented (e.g., a math class or history lesson), adults are more problem-centered in their approach to learning. They want to learn what will help them solve problems or deal with situations they face in everyday life.

- **Motivation**: While adults can be responsive to external motivators (like promotions or higher salaries), they are generally more motivated by internal factors. These can include the satisfaction of achieving personal goals, solving problems, or the pleasure of learning itself.